Nursing Essentials

Priority: Before every dose: verify the indication, contraindications, route, monitoring, and ordered response to adverse effects.

FOCUS 1

Monitor labor

- **Oxytocin:** high-alert infusion for induction / augmentation; monitor contractions and fetal status with a controlled pump.
- **Concerning tracing / tachysystole:** reduce or stop per protocol, assess reversible causes, and escalate.
- **Tocolytics:** selected short-term use may permit steroids or transfer; monitor agent-specific blood pressure and heart-rate effects.

FOCUS 2

Prevent seizures

- **Magnesium sulfate:** seizure prophylaxis / treatment and selected fetal neuroprotection; it is not the primary antihypertensive.
- **Monitor:** respiratory status, reflexes, urine output, and ordered laboratory findings; impaired clearance raises toxicity risk.
- **Suspected toxicity:** stop the infusion, call for help, support breathing, and prepare ordered calcium gluconate.

FOCUS 3

Control bleeding

- **Oxytocin:** commonly first-line for uterine atony; continue assessment for other bleeding causes.
- **Methylergonovine:** avoid with hypertension / preeclampsia. **Carboprost:** avoid with asthma.
- **Tranexamic acid:** supports clot stability; give promptly when indicated under the hemorrhage pathway, ideally within 3 hours of birth.

Other high-yield therapies

Make it stick: Connect each medication to the client's asthma, blood pressure, renal function, and treatment goal.

Focus	What to know	Nursing application
Antenatal corticosteroids	support fetal maturation when preterm-birth criteria are met; monitor glucose as indicated.	Check eligibility and glucose
Rh immune globulin	prevents sensitization in eligible unsensitized Rh-negative clients; timing depends on the event and guidance.	Verify Rh status and timing
Antibiotics	verify allergy history and indication—GBS prophylaxis, infection treatment, and surgical prophylaxis are different plans.	Check allergies and indication

RED FLAGS · ESCALATE PROMPTLY

Stop and escalate suspected medication toxicity, respiratory depression, chest pain, severe hypotension, or concerning fetal / maternal deterioration.